

Chicago Tribune



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MONDAY, MAY 19, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Zelenskyy talks with Vance, Rubio

Trump, Putin plan telephone call to discuss ending war

By Giada Zampano and Elise Morton
Associated Press

ROME, Italy — Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy met Sunday with top U.S. officials and European leaders in Rome, ahead of a high-stakes phone call Monday between U.S. President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin on ending the war in Ukraine.

The discussions came as Russia launched what Ukraine called its largest drone barrage against Ukraine since the start of its full-scale invasion in 2022, after the first direct talks in years between Moscow and Kyiv failed to yield a ceasefire Friday.

Zelenskyy spoke with U.S. Vice President JD Vance and Secretary of State Marco Rubio at the U.S. ambassador's residence, after attending the inaugural Mass for Pope Leo XIV in St. Peter's Square.

Zelenskyy said on social media that he had underscored the need for "real diplomacy" and reaffirmed Ukraine's commitment to a "full and unconditional ceasefire."

He said they discussed sanctions against Russia, bilateral trade, defense cooperation and plans for the upcoming prisoner exchange with Russia that was agreed in talks between the two sides in Istanbul.

Trump has said he plans to speak with Putin about stopping the "bloodbath" in Ukraine and then speak to Zelenskyy and leaders of various NATO countries.

The morning also marked the new pope's first steps into a global role.

Pope Leo XIV celebrated an outdoor Mass formally inaugurating him as the 267th pope of the Roman Catholic Church, telling world leaders, the assembled hierarchy of his church and more than 100,000 faithful gathered in St. Peter's Square that the church needs

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Pope Leo XIV greets cheering crowds as he arrives for Mass in St. Peter's Square in the Vatican on Sunday. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

'I come to you as a brother'

Pope Leo XIV officially begins his papacy with inaugural Mass in St. Peter's Square

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

VATICAN CITY — Chicago native Pope Leo XIV called for unity in an increasingly divided world Sunday during his inaugural Mass in St. Peter's Square, marking the official start of his historic papacy as the first American-born pontiff.

The 69-year-old Augustinian priest, a longtime missionary, also urged care for the environment and well-being of the poor, causes championed by his late predecessor, Pope Francis.

"Brothers and sisters, I would like that our first great desire be for a united church, a sign of unity and communion, which becomes a leaven for a reconciled world," the new pope, who grew up in the south suburbs, declared during his homily. "In this time ... we still see too much discord, too many wounds caused by hatred, violence, prejudice, the fear of difference, and an economic paradigm that exploits the Earth's resources and marginalizes the poorest."



Pope Leo XIV reacts after receiving the fisherman's ring during the Mass.

Billowy white clouds flanked the iconic dome of St. Peter's Basilica as gulls soared across the sunny blue sky. About 150,000 people filled the square to witness the pope's first Mass, according to the Holy See press office. Most of those worshippers stood shoulder to shoulder

on the square, surrounded by the piazza's majestic 284-column curved colonnades, designed to represent the church embracing humanity.

Statues of 140 saints adorn the top of the landmark's 284 columns and 88 pilasters, gazing down at visitors below.

Men, women and children stretched out onto Via della Conciliazione, the roughly 1,600-foot-long cobblestone thoroughfare that links the piazza to the Tiber River. Large screens lined the avenue so even those far away could witness the new pope formally begin his term as the 267th pontiff.

Travelers from the Chicago area were in attendance, hoping to get a glimpse of their home-grown pontiff. Among those spectators were students from Loyola University Chicago's Arrupe College.

"For me, it's a moment in history," said Esdaini Lopez, 20, who lives on the Southwest Side of Chicago.

She was raised in an atheist household but has been exploring her faith since attending a Jesuit school.

"It's really a beautiful thing," she said.

The students were already in Rome on an annual trip to Catholic pilgrimage sites, a visit

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Housing nonprofit faces \$10M shortfall

Organization provides subsidies for very low-income renters

By Lizzie Kane
Chicago Tribune

Adrienne Nelson was living with her sister in a studio apartment in the Uptown neighborhood. They were comfortable, getting by on their dual incomes, paying off bills both old and new. Their monthly rent and utility costs were around \$1,200. They called that studio home for nearly 10 years.

But then, in a matter of months, Nelson found herself "homeless and sister-less," she said.

She lost her job, her sister died and she could no longer afford to pay the rent. She wound up couch surfing with friends and in a homeless shelter for about a year and a half. Nelson said she felt "desperate and lost."

While living at the shelter, she got a call to let her know that she would be receiving a subsidized housing unit.



Adrienne Nelson receives a housing subsidy from the Chicago Low-Income Housing Trust Fund to help her pay the rent on her apartment in Chicago's Uptown neighborhood. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

"I said 'Yahoo!' at the top of my voice," Nelson said. "The nervousness of how am I going to survive" eased.

Now 68 and retired, Nelson has lived in a subsidized one-bedroom unit for about 10 years in Uptown and relies on her roughly \$1,000 monthly Social Security payments to afford her approximately \$230 monthly portion of rent and other expenses.

Nelson's housing subsidy comes from the Chicago Low-Income Housing Trust Fund, an organization in charge of funding and administering more than 3,000 rental subsidies for individuals and families to use in the private

market, including migrants.

The trust fund is staring down an estimated \$10 million shortfall for its \$14.1 million 2025 budget as two of its funding streams have dried up. That number represents subsidies for about 600 units. The trust fund said it has sufficient reserves to fill the budget hole for this year. It has also begun a subsidy attrition plan for units that are or will become vacant as of Jan. 1 (the start of its new budget cycle) to reduce costs. About 16% of those subsidies will not be subject to attrition as they are part of a special program serving those

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Officers observed for problem traffic stops before Reed killing

Five had been named in investigations by accountability office

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

The five tactical officers for months were on the radar of the Civilian Office of Police Accountability.

From mid-2023 through March 2024 — the month 26-year-old Dexter Reed was killed in a shootout during a traffic stop in the 3800 block of West Ferdinand — those five cops were named in at least four separate COPA investigations that stemmed from traffic stops initiated in the Chicago Police

Department's Harrison District (11th).

The fatal shooting of Reed, a former basketball player at Westinghouse College Prep high school who shot a police officer moments before he was killed, laid bare longstanding tensions between Chicago's police and the investigators who probe officers' use of deadly force.

The officers involved repeatedly violated rules involving motorist traffic stops, investigators found. And, after months of public discord, the leaders of the city's police department and its oversight agency reached the same conclusion: The officers needed to be suspended.

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Biden diagnosed with cancer

The prostate cancer is an aggressive form, with the cells having spread to the bone, his office said. **Nation & World**

Cubs complete City Series sweep

The Cubs defeated the White Sox 6-2 in the third game of a series marked by Sox mistakes. **Chicago Sports**

